



10 steps to assertiveness

Once you have identified areas in which you would like to be more assertive, draw up a list of specific personal examples. Each item on this list, then needs to be rated on a scale of 0 – 10 (where 0 represents no difficulty), and arranged in order of difficulty, with the easiest at the top and hardest at the bottom.

Example:

1. Asking your boss for a pay rise **9/10**
2. Refuse Jim's request the next time he asks for a loan **8/10**
3. Asking neighbour to return the lawnmower **8/10**
4. Sending food back in a restaurant **7/10**
5. Ask your mother not to smoke in the house **6/10**
6. Return a jumper to the shop **5/10**
7. Congratulating Jane on passing her exam **5/10**
8. Saying no to extra hours at work **4/10**
9. Telling Frank you don't understand the video **3/10**
10. Invite the neighbour round for a drink **2/10**

Now, you can start to work on your difficulties in an ordered and graded way. By starting with the easiest situations, we quickly gain skill and our confidence grows accordingly. This will have the effect of making the more difficult situations less daunting.

